

Ricardo (Zhicong) Xie

Manufacturing / Site Project Intern | CAD-to-Part, Workshop Practice and Coordination

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Valid NZ student visa | No sponsorship required | 25h/week during semester | Full-time 17 Nov 2026 - late Feb 2027

PROFILE

- Mechanical engineering master's student with hands-on exposure to laser cutting, CNC machining, 3D printing workflow, automotive structures, CAD modelling and project coordination.
- Interested in manufacturing, production support, site/project engineering and contractor environments where drawing-to-part thinking, practical judgement and workshop communication matter.
- Project screenshots and source links: <https://zxie588-alt.github.io>

EDUCATION

University of Auckland - Master of Engineering Studies, Mechanical Engineering | 2026 - Present

Current study and project work in building services, smart manufacturing, CFD/thermal modelling, composite structures and engineering methods. Relevant coursework: Manufacturing Processes, CNC Machining, Design for Manufacture, Manufacturing and Industrial Systems

Huazhong Agricultural University - Bachelor of Engineering, Mechanical Engineering / Mechatronics | 2021 - 2025

Mechanical design, CAD, electrotechnics, sensors, embedded control and mechatronic system integration.

PRACTICAL AND TEAM EXPERIENCE

- Manufacturing workshop training: prepared AutoCAD/DXF laser-cut profiles, compared drawing intent with cut parts, and worked around CNC workflow, workholding, chip formation and shop-floor safety awareness.
- Engineering practice: interpreted force-displacement test output, practised robotic arm control, and acted as a small-group lead explaining automotive seat/interior structures to peers.
- Technical visual communication: former student news-department lead with photography/event documentation experience; professional working English and native Mandarin.

PROJECT WORK

Manufacturing Workshop Training & DXF Preparation

Laser cutting, AutoCAD/DXF, CNC machining exposure, 3D printing workflow

- Prepared 2D AutoCAD/DXF geometry for laser cutting and engraving, then compared drawing intent with the physical cut plate.
- Observed and practised CNC machining workflow including workholding, spindle/tool motion, cutting fluid, chip formation and basic workshop safety protocols aligned with general WorkSafe NZ expectations.
- Reviewed machined gear and shaft components to connect CAD features with real manufacturing constraints such as tolerances, edge quality and tool access.

Engineering Practice and Automotive Structure Training

Mechanics testing, robotic arm control, automotive structure walkthrough

- Worked with mechanics testing equipment and interpreted force-displacement results from a physical test setup.
- Practised robotic arm control and basic automation interaction in a lab setting.
- Acted as a small-group lead during automotive structure training, explaining seat/interior structures and vehicle-system context to peers.

Ruggedized Outdoor IoT Sensor Module Design Package

SolidWorks, enclosure design, DFM notes, Keil C, validation workflow

- Designed a SolidWorks enclosure design package with screw bosses, gasket stack-up, PCB and battery envelopes, cable/strap mounts and service access.
- Applied DFM principles to improve enclosure features for CNC machining review and 3D-print prototype preparation.
- Added FEA-style screening for corner load, strap lug and screw boss regions; kept an open test list for sealing, impact, thermal exposure and firmware validation.
- Built prototype firmware in Keil C with sensor-driver abstraction, battery monitoring and a simple module state machine; documented the electronics and firmware architecture in the portfolio.

NZ Residential MVHR / ERV Ventilation Design

Revit MEP coordination, SolidWorks, AutoCAD/DXF, HVAC sizing, NZBC G4/H1 context, commissioning plan

- Developed a New Zealand residential MVHR/ERV ventilation design aligned with local building-code and building-services workflow expectations.
- Modelled the MVHR unit, supply/extract/outdoor/exhaust ducts, diffusers, grilles and hangers in SolidWorks; exported DXF, STEP, STL, PNG and a component list for review.
- Added a Revit MEP coordination workflow with view/sheet structure, mechanical-system naming, duct-terminal schedule fields and access/commissioning checks.
- Sized the system for 60 L/s balanced supply/extract in normal operation and 85 L/s boost extract mode, calculating external static pressure targets of about 80 Pa and 120 Pa.
- Checked the design against NZBC G4/H1 and Healthy Homes ventilation context; developed a commissioning test plan covering CO2, humidity, airflow and fan-power measurements.

Orbital AI Data Centre Feasibility Study - Systems Lead

Stakeholders, requirements, ConOps, trade studies, risk, verification

- Led the systems-engineering workstream for a 5-person team study covering a 24-satellite LEO AI data-centre architecture.
- Set up the stakeholder map, requirements hierarchy, ConOps, architecture options, trade-study criteria, risk register and verification gates.
- Delivered a feasibility-report structure with trade-off matrices, risk logic and verification-gate framework across orbit/coverage, power, thermal rejection, communications, launch mass, cost and sustainability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Proficient in: drawing-to-part thinking, AutoCAD/DXF laser-cut preparation, SolidWorks assemblies, STEP/STL export and component documentation
- Familiar with: CNC machining workflow, workholding, cutting fluid, chip formation, 3D printing workflow and basic workshop safety awareness
- Project support: technician/workshop communication, on-site task support, risk tracking, requirements and verification workflow